



Carina Nebula

This remarkable image of part of the Carina Nebula was captured by the Hubble Space Telescope. Inside this enormous pillar of dust and gas, stars are being born.

The nebula comprises mostly hydrogen and helium, but also contains the debris from old stars that exploded long ago. Gravity pulls all of this matter into clumps that heat up and begin to shine, their light and other radiation sculpting the cloud with jets and swirls. The Carina Nebula lies 7,500 light-years away, in our own galaxy, the Milky Way.